

DIEGO MARADONA

A Socio-Cultural Study

Edited by Pablo Brescia and Mariano Paz

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MARADONA AND MUSIC

Soundscapes and Echoes of
the Maradonian Song¹

Martín Virgili

Translated by Dolores Gadler

If I were Maradona

This chapter approaches the figure of Maradona from the perspective of sound studies, considering the footballer as a body that produces sounds and relationships between sounds. For this, we must accept the *inscriptions of sound in his body* and ask ourselves “what would things be like if one were (namely, felt, sensed, imagined, acted like, or became) a certain type of person?” (Feld, 2013: 218). How would things be if we were Maradona? In the same way, we should pay attention to the sound marks that he left in Argentinian society and think of the materiality in which those marks reverberate in culture and in the landscape. The echo seems to be the matter. Murray Schafer (1993) was the first to state that the sounds that people emit both in music and in language are always echoes of the surrounding landscape, establishing a deep and invisible connection. In addition, the songs dedicated to Maradona portray a landscape nourished by the booming daily life of a city: they are the echo of those times, like a background noise that is woven beyond stadiums.

The aim of this chapter is to reflect on the meanings behind the sounds we associate with Maradona. Are the roars celebrating Maradona's goals at the Azteca Stadium not analogous to the cries of protest in a popular mobilisation? Or to the lyrics “The fight, the fight/We're going to win!” by the Vj Awax?² I am picturing a sound image: Maradona as a *soundboard*, proved by the Neapolitan mantra “O mamma, mamma, mamma/sai perché mi batte il cuore?/Ho visto Maradona” (Oh mum, mum, mum/do you know why my heart beats?/I've seen Maradona). The following sections explore acoustemology, understood as the epistemological study of acoustics (Feld, 2013: 222), soundscape, and musical analysis to understand the connection between Maradona and sound.

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Maradona was pierced, as was an excess and a symptom “se quede” (Let him stay, let him barely nine years old, was on pitch, to entertain the audience Juniors match, to the “Maradona to him in 2020 in the Gimnasia many, especially in Argentina and from an acoustic point of view, without endlessly and sung by great men the world. Maradona himself remembered national team at the beginning of 19 stands chanting my name: Maradood, me. My legs and hands were shaking. kidding, I was shitting myself” (Marad

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The sound and the fury: Screaming the name Maradona

I was born in Argentina, in the city of Buenos Aires. I did not grow up in a "football-loving" family; football, like tango and *lunfardo*, was a lurking force that I recognised by its sound. When I spent time with my maternal grandfather, he would tune in to tango stations. On Sundays, the sound dynamics got feverish as the radio broadcasts transmitted the local football championship and the airwaves were filled with movement and excitement. The football commentary was an in-between event; it was and it was not song. I knew by heart the cadences and stops, the pauses and vocal juxtapositions preceding the announcements, which required the same amount of energy as the lead voice. The sound action moved through the cadences of the Spanish word *gol* (goal) that was shouted and sung at the same time, stretching the "o" (*goooooooooo*) and in *crescendo* with the intention of embracing the listeners with the voice.

In the 1980s, Argentina returned to democracy after a violent period of dictatorship. That return brought with it a new disposition of sound relationships. A sound-cry resurfaced after years of silence, whispers, and murmurs. Once again, the street was occupied by bodies that made noise and that got together to produce sound with greater intensity. When I was ten years old, a new presence was born, which, even without a face, was also a sound, a story, an emotion: the 1986 World Cup in Mexico. It was not until the game between Argentina and Italy that I realised that the country was immersed in something emotionally unique. I was on a school bus with my classmates when the driver started yelling "goool" frenziedly together with the teachers accompanying us. And they all started to sing: "Olé olé olé olé, Diegooo, Diegooo" repeatedly, like a mantra that we also joined. "Diego" became a cry associated with joy and amazement. I could hear that simple name at school, at the cinema, at the supermarket, everywhere.

Maradona was pierced, adored, and besieged by sounds throughout his life. It was an excess and a symptom. Fifty years elapsed from that "Que se quede, que se quede" (Let him stay, let him stay!) shouted in July 1970, when Maradona, barely nine years old, was doing his tricks with the ball in the centre of the pitch, to entertain the audience during half-time in an Argentinos Juniors-Boca Juniors match, to the "Maradoooó, Maradoooó" cried during the tribute paid to him in 2020 in the Gimnasia y Esgrima La Plata Stadium. During this time, many, especially in Argentina and Italy, established an asymmetric relationship, from an acoustic point of view, with Maradona's body. His name has been cried out endlessly and sung by great monophonic choirs in many stadiums around the world. Maradona himself remembers when he debuted with the Argentinian national team at the beginning of 1977: "I started warming up and I heard the stands chanting my name: Maradoooó, Maradoooó! I don't know what came over me. My legs and hands were shaking. The crowd's roar was so loud ... I'm not kidding, I was shitting myself" (Maradona, 2021: 20). During a football match

playing for Barcelona against Seville in January of 1984, something similar happened to him:

We beat them 3-1. I scored two goals, the second and the third. When we were 2-0 up, the people began to ask El Flaco [César Luis Menotti] to take me off so they could applaud me. It was then that Sevilla pulled one back and everyone shut up. I scored the third and they started again until Menotti took me off. The stadium went wild, they were all shouting and clapping, it was more than the classic "Maradoó, Maradoó!" I don't know ... it was like a shriek: it's one of the ovations that I remember most clearly of my whole career. No one could believe it.

Maradona 2021: 72

He was 24 years old at the time. He would still have to hear the "roar" during in Mexico 1986 and in Italy, over the 1987 and 1989 championships, the yells and whistles at the 1990 World Cup in Italy, and the ovations and cries in his farewell in Boca Juniors in 2001, to mention a few significant moments. The sound accompanied him till the end: on the day of his death, the mere presence of the coffin summoned his name.

Maradona was the constant receiver of a significant, acoustic, and symbolic sound flow, and he had to learn to live with those sounds and to endure them. He had to control the quivering these chants produced in him. He had to stabilise his body. In this sense, Bernhard Waldenfels talks about the capacity of bodily resonance, "which allows the voice of Another to *resonate* in one's own body (and vice versa)", determining a "response register" to dialogue with the world (quoted in Rosa, 2019: 88). So, if "hearing and sound production are embodied competences that place the actors and their acting capacity in specific historical worlds" (Feld, 2013: 222), where do we place Maradona's body? What reactions, what "reflex acts" do these sounds produce? And, also, what perceptions and emotions are felt by the people when they recognise themselves as part of the group that produces those sounds?³ What happens to music when it discovers these sounds, when it perceives 100,000 people chanting "Maradoóó, Maradoóó ..."? Stretching the "o" at the end, "Maradoóó", is a football chant that encompasses a whole structure of sounds and attitudes, such as the *aguante* and different choreographic participatory gestures.⁴ It is a compact and energetic sound, a simple chant of tribute and gratitude that over time has acquired other meanings. For example, it could become a protest, shouted by the public when an Argentinian national team was playing poorly, or a compliment, when someone did something outstanding (Soriano, 2020: 89).

Argentinian musicians and singers belonging to various genres (popular music, cumbia, rock) have used this chant: Pocho "La Pantera" (1993), in "Maradona no perdona"; Julio Lacarra, in "Dale 10" (1995); Los Piojos, in "Maradó" (1996); and Rodrigo, in "La mano de Dios" (2000), among many others. On the one hand, these songs amplify a public and mass sound/landscape, the sound of the stadium

and the fans, with the intention of making it reverberate in the musical composition. On the other hand, it is Maradona who returns the inscriptions of the sound in his body to the musical community, by resisting that sound and by showing society that there is only one recipient for that sound load: him. And society listens to that resistance. When Maradona himself sings "La mano de Dios", as it can be seen in a scene in the 2008 film *Maradona by Kusturica*, he changes the personal pronouns in the original lyrics from the third person to the first person and never chants the chorus "Maradó, Maradó". He stays silent. He only knows how to receive that sound: his function in society is to be at the receiving end of this symbolic force, to assimilate it and give it back.

Along these lines, the use of the chant by Los Piojos, one of the most popular Argentinian rock bands in the 1990s, appears more like a cry of war and resistance. Pablo Alabarces considers that the band saw in Maradona the "symbol of a lost authenticity that links rock to football" (2002: 147) given the Argentinian social and political context in the 1990s. However, we also hear how Maradona gives back to his community *the control of those sounds*. By then, he had already reached the peak of his career and had also gone through several very critical moments. Those who chanted his name were not a homogeneous group²: Maradonians and also his detractors were beginning to emerge. Thus, the "Maradó" sung by Los Piojos is more spasmodic, with a different energy charge. The musical accompaniment is dizzying and anxious: it does not sound like the uproar of a football pitch as in the other songs. It is not a chant that everyone wants to sing, but rather it is a choir that summons those who feel called to the cause. It is an energetic and resistant chant, like the euphoria that precedes a confrontation.

Maradona's body is reactive to mass sound. He knows how to handle, accept, and negotiate that difference. In the 1990 World Cup final at the Olympic Stadium in Rome, Italy, the audience witnessed a moment of tension between the fans and Maradona for the first time. The Italian public began to jeer and boo the Argentinian National Anthem with the players lined up on the pitch before the match. The TV cameras captured each player in close-up, singing along, until it reached Maradona, the only player who reacted, shouting back "sons of bitches, sons of bitches". At this point in his career, the sound no longer intimidated him. It did not exercise its coercive function on him. His body knew and recognised the affective influences and the tremors of sound and could for that very reason engage in a duel with its forces. Los Piojos together with Mano Negra in "Santa Maradona" were the first bands to dedicate songs to Maradona which emphasised his critical position towards power and presented him as a model of resistance. That defiant bond will later reverberate on young trap, rap, and hip-hop artists from different countries, who will incorporate it and recycle it in their own contexts. In different ways, an attitude of rebellion, marginality, courage, position towards power, confrontation, and danger is heard in songs and described in videos such as "Maradona" (2017), by the Nigerian singer Niniola; "Maradona" (2018), by the French rapper Lacrim; "Maradona" (2019), by the Kosovo rapper Xhani; "Maradona" (2019), by the Italian rapper Colza; "O,

Plomień 81, Maradona" (2020), by Polish rappers Onar and Paweł Kapliński, and "Maradona" (2020) by Italians MC Kliton & Kido, to name a few. Here, the word "Maradona" once again invokes the echo of a safe response to a threatening situation, be it due to "street problems", "sexist violence", "the challenge of recovering from a childhood of deprivation and poverty", and "the daily dangers of suburban neighbourhoods". It is as if somehow the musical *underground* had found in Maradona's figure and word a robust sign to renew its content, or as if his presence had acted as a "sound tattoo" embodying many different meanings in a single gesture.

Maradonian soundscapes: The Maradonian rhythm

As soon as Maradona's death was announced, at noon on November 25, 2020, the Maradonian resonance began to unfold. Radio stations, television, social networks, and news websites started to broadcast songs, footage from his playing career, with an emphasis on his renowned goals and dribbles, excerpts of interviews with his emblematic phrases, the clips in which he sang alone or accompanied by renowned artists, and all kinds of sound expressions added to his voice. People in the street shouted and sang his name; the wind brought and carried away "Diego did not die/Diego did not die/Diego lives in his people/fucking hell", "Olé, olé, olé olé/Diego, Diego". After his death, the sound that had accompanied him since his childhood re-emerged as a spectre that bore his name and his story. In death, he was different too.

When considering Maradona's relationship with sound, rhythm may be the first recognisable parameter. As a child, he stood out for his skills hitting the ball and his keepie uppies. He grew up listening to the rhythm produced by the sound of his foot hitting a ball: *tac, tac, tac, tac*. Modest but effective percussion, his listening regarded that sound of leather (or any of the other materials of his early improvised balls), in counterpoint with his inner heartbeat.⁶ Rhythm functioned as his centre of gravity and a positional and levelling reference; above all, it determined the way he moved:

Everything I did, every step I took, was because of the ball. If la Tota [Maradona's mother] sent me on an errand I would take with me anything that resembled a ball: it could be an orange, or scrunpled-up paper, or cloths. And I would go up the steps on to the bridge that crossed the railway, hopping on one foot, the right one, and taking whatever it was on the left, *tac, tac, tac* That's how I walked to school as well.

Maradona, 2021: 3

Maradona had rhythm: his foot kept hitting any object he could find, with the regularity of a ticking clock. For this reason, he understood the inertial behaviour of rhythms, their speed, and markings. "A juggler doesn't spend the entire show throwing the balls up", says Michael Cerveris, Tony Award-winning actor

Maradona's relationship compared to that of other players in the vanguard of the highest expression of Argentinean football (Archetti, 2003: 21). The theorist and musician and the independent intellectual in *The Wellsp* mental music are uttered a 'melodious' sense, but the control of a brain melody" (quoted in Ba

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and singer. "Half the time, the juggler is waiting for them to fall" (Biguenet, 2015: 75). Similarly, Maradona perceived an active time and a time on pause. His ability to deceive his opponents had to do with controlling the game as a whole and with the changes of pace (knowing how to see and feel the pause). César Luis Menotti, who coached him at the Youth World Cup in 1979 and again at the World Cup in 1982, explained those abilities: "He easily dribbles his way into the opposition's half. The goal is always in his sight. He consistently finds a pass to the best-placed teammate. His short passes and shots are pure wonder, *with a prodigious change of pace*" (Menotti, 2020; my emphasis).

Eduardo Archetti studied the exchange of bodily meanings between football and dance. He observed that the transformation of the tango in Argentina in the 1920s and 1930s coincided with the consolidation of a football playing style. The informants in his research believed that dribbling and dancing were related. In tango, the changes of rhythm in a step are expressed through the figures *cortes y quebradas* (literally cuts and breaks), which also invoke the great dribblers in Argentinian football. According to one of the informants:

The *corte* is a sudden pause, an unexpected break in the dancing and in the figures; it is not movement. Much dribbling in football is a *corte*, a player stopping and at the same time controlling the ball. A *corte* can eliminate a defender and can help to change direction, as in tango. On the contrary, a *quebrada* is an athletic contortion, a dramatic movement, and a rapid improvisation with the legs and the waist, avoiding physical contact with the opponents. The essence of tango dancing was a combination of *cortes* and *quebradas*.

The best Argentinian players, and Maradona is the most fantastic example, based their way of playing on *cortes* and *quebradas*.

2003: 225

Maradona's relationship with the ball from the point of view of sound can be compared to that of a musician who improvises with his instrument. His skills are considered "an art"; according to Alejandro Apo, he was "the most artistic of all players in the world" (2020: 50), a genius of the corporal improvisation whose highest expression in football was dribbling – which, in the "creole style" of Argentinian football, was regarded as the fundamental identity trait of the sport (Archetti, 2003: 219).

The theorist and improviser Derek Bailey describes the link between the musician and the instrument as a generative bodily principle arising from an autonomous intelligence. Bailey recalls Curt Sachs' definition of the term instrumental in *The Wellsprings of Music*: "The original concepts of vocal and instrumental music are utterly different. The instrumental impulse is not melody in a 'melodious' sense, but an agile movement of the hands that seems to be under the control of a brain center totally different from that which inspires the vocal melody" (quoted in Bailey, 2010: 182). Bailey observes that it is the "attitude of

Maradonian songs.⁸ Maradona speaks about these lists in his autobiography. Out of the many songs, Maradona mentions those by Andrés Calamaro, Los Piojos, Mano Negra, and Julio Lacarra but goes on to add that his favourite is “La Mano de Dios”, by Rodrigo, which he considers the most beautiful song about him ever done, and whose lyrics he knows by heart.

When does this relation between Maradona and the song begin? If we consider dates and places, the founding moment of the Maradonian song can be traced back to June 22, 1986, at the Azteca Stadium in Mexico City. Before that date in Argentina, there are no songs dedicated to Diego. During the World Cup quarter finals between Argentina and England, Maradona metaphorically transmutes from human to God.⁹ There is no other goal that has been commented with so much emphasis and that is so linked to a sound since its conception. Its author has perceived this and comments: “In my view, that second goal is set to music. And the music is Víctor Hugo Morales’s commentary. I’ve had to watch and hear that goal in English, Japanese, German ... But Víctor Hugo’s commentary is like no other” (Maradona, 2016: 172).¹⁰

That same day, before the game was even finished, Peteco Carabajal composed “La canción del brujito” (The Little Wizard’s Song), the first Maradonian song. In an interview, Carabajal recalls:

I had a melody without a theme. When Argentina played against England during the 1986 World Cup, where Maradona scored two goals, one with the “Hand of God” and the other when he rushed off from midfield, I was watching the game on my own. For the second goal, when begins his run, I sat up on the bed, as if something great was about to happen That moment, I decided that the lyrics I was going to write for that melody would have to do with that particular skill that only some people have.

2020

However, the Maradonian song precedes Maradona. The sounds of football had already preceded his own history. On May 20, 1942, Reinaldo Yiso and Juan Puey recorded in Buenos Aires the tango “El sueño del pibe” (The Dream of the Pibe). The song tells the story of a young football player who receives an invitation for a trial from a club he supports. That night he dreams of becoming a star. If we pay attention to the lyrics, Maradona and the *pibe* from the tango have almost everything in common: their humble origins, their desire to succeed in a big club, the need to earn money to help their families, and their dream of scoring a match-winning goal. The tango says: “Dribbling past everybody he faced the goalkeeper/and with a strong kick he opened the score”.

In 1994, Maradona sang this tango on a television show called *La verdad de la milanesa* but he replaced the names of the football players in the song, mentioning instead Mario Kempes, Jorge Olguín, and himself.¹¹ In his autobiography, he says that this is one of his favourite tangos and adds: “I don’t know why, maybe because it has a lot to do with me. In fact, when I sing it I change the names

of the characters and I include myself" (Maradona, 2000: 267). The life of that *pibe* reverberates in Maradona's own life and both are joined by the same sounds: "The stadium packed, glorious Sunday/at last they were going to see him play in the first division". We already know how stadiums sound: the *pibe* and Maradona feel the same, they hear the same. This resonance multiplies and deepens in the lyrics of "La vida es una tómbola" [Life is a Lottery] by Manu Chao (2007). In the line "If I were Maradona" the singer puts himself in the footballer's place, trying to see the world like him. Maradona feels like the *pibe* in the tango and Manu Chao ... does he not feel like Maradona and the *pibe* at the same time? The three share the same situation in this song: the humble origin and the yearning for success dissociated from economic power and aimed at collective emotion and motivating passions and sound.

But the resonance game does not end here. The Argentinian rock group La Beriso presented in 2003 its album *Solo canciones* and included its own version of "El sueño del pibe". The arrangement begins with an electric guitar introduction with typical tango tempo markings, followed by the voice in the first verse. In the second one, the drums and bass are added, harmonising the initial line of the guitar. In the third verse "Mommy dear I'll make money", the band speeds up the *tempo* and takes the song into punk territory. The band also changes the lyrics and includes Maradona among the footballers that the child admires. Once again, a singer puts himself in Maradona's place. After a vertiginous bridge dominated by the guitar, the band lowers the decibels in the penultimate verse and in the last verse they release the musical intensity again. In this part, the famous commentary of Maradona's goal by Víctor Hugo Morales is added as part of the musical material. The same formula can be found in other Maradonian songs such as in "Homenaje al 10" (Homage to Number 10) (2005), by Antonio Ríos, and "El gol del siglo" (The Goal of the Century) (2020), by Daniel Devita, but in La Beriso's version the commentary is directly connected to the tango lyrics, showing that the *pibe* has always been Maradona.

Another important theme in the Maradonian song are the echoes of the Malvinas/Falklands war. It appears in several songs by Argentinian bands and artists that emerged in the 1990s as "Maradó", by Los Piojos; "Ángel vengador" (Revengeful Angel) (2001), by Zumbadores; "La cueca de Maradona" (Maradona's Cueca) (2001), by Guillermo Guido; "Barrilete cósmico" (Cosmic Kite) (2006), by El Farolito; "¿Qué es Dios?" (What is God?) (2008), by Las Pastillas del Abuelo; and "Gloria al 10" (Glory to Number 10) (2011), by Pampa Yakuza, among others. In these lyrics, Maradona is portrayed as a peaceful redeemer. The question is: are the sounds of that war also inscribed in his body? The song "El gol del siglo" (The Goal of the Century) by rapper Daniel Devita puts together three types of soundscapes that reverberate on Maradona's body: (a) the war soundscape (gunshots, hymns, tears, euphoria, silences, and a shaking ground); (b) the football soundscape, since the artist, rather than describing the goal, evokes once more Víctor Hugo, who becomes part of the song with his commentary; and (c) the tango landscape, which is represented by the use of the bandoneon in the

introduction and also alludes to the fact of "being Argentinian". The lyrics are about 700 words. Maradona's name, however, is never mentioned: he appears as a mirror of those intertwined landscapes, as an echo of war, football, and tango.

The last echo that I will discuss is the one I identify with the figure of the prayer. Before the Maradonian Church was created, music had already raised its prayers. Mano Negra in his "Santa Maradona" (1994) openly asked (in French): "Santa Maradona pray for us". But there are many further examples, especially among Argentinian musicians, most of them very popular. They include: "Y dale alegría, alegría a mi corazón/es lo único que te pido al menos hoy" (And joy to my heart/it's the only thing I ask of you, at least today) (Fito Paez, "Y dale alegría a mi corazón" [And Bring Joy to My Heart] 1991); "Cabeza de mi patria, pueblo, santo y pecador" (Head of my country, people, saint and sinner) (Ataque 77, "Francotirador" [Sniper], 1997); "Es verdad que el Diego es lo más grande que hay/es nuestra religión, nuestra identidad" (It is true that Diego is the greatest ever/he's our religion, our identity) (Ratones Paranoicos, "Para siempre Diego" [Forever Diego], 2001); "Hoy en Italia sos más que un santo/Está San Genaro y luego estás vos ... No te mueras nunca/Diego Armando" (In Italy today you are more than a saint/There is Saint Genaro and then there is you ... Don't ever die, Diego Armando) (Terminal Tango, "No te mueras nunca" [Don't Ever Die], 2001); "Ya más nadie iba a manguearle/milagros a San Genaro/porque entrabas a jugar" (Nobody asked anymore for/miracles by San Genaro/because you were on the field) (La Guardia Hereje, "Para verte gambetear" [To See You Dribble], 2004); "Por tus milagros a mano/Y el milagro de tus pies/Muchas gracias señor dios/Muchas gracias señor diez" (For your handy miracles/for the miracle of your feet/Many thanks Mr. God/Many thanks Mr. Ten) (Las Pastillas del Abuelo, "¿Qué es Dios?" [What is God?] 2008); "Nadie sabe bien con qué poderes/rezan hombres y mujeres/por una mano de dios" (Nobody knows well with what powers/pray men and women/for the Hand of God) (David de Gregorio, "Barrilete cósmico" [Cosmic Kite], 2017).

What does the sound of this obsession with the divine and religious tells us? Why the prayer? Popular culture has no doubts: the word "Maradona" is the centre of a prayer. To say it is to be protected. A war correspondent in Iraq relates that "in a trench the only existing photo was one of Diego wearing the Argentinian T-shirt ... we are at war and this Iraqi felt protected by Diego, how can you explain it?" (Caldeira, 2007: 25). In this way: Maradona is like home, built by the everyday way of his sounds and his way of speaking and expressing himself. But above all, Maradona is a name and a sound that everyone can make their own.¹² Esquirol declares that "the essential thing in language is protection" and that deep down there is a prayer, "as when one places the hands in front of the body to avoid impact" (2015: 157). That gesture and the prayer are closely related because words are comforting: "The word acts like a coat and the text is its fabric" (Esquirol, 2015: 158). The prayer appears as a primordial sound, the cry for help before the unknown, the hand that is raised so that we can be rescued. Maradona was there to rescue us from the uncertainty. That is

why people ask, pray, and worship Maradona. It could even be stated that the National Decree 936/2020 of November 25, 2020, which declared three days of National Mourning in Argentina following Maradona's death, perfected his word as a home and refuge, in addition to making his name the reverberation of a country: "Beyond his individual and group achievements as a footballer ... he has represented the Argentinian people before the world, in such a way that the word 'ARGENTINA' immediately brings back 'MARADONA'".¹³

Final echo

Probably, in the next World Cup Maradona's name will be called out in a stadium, but he will no longer be there to receive the chants. What will happen to those sounds? What meanings will they evoke? They will give shape to two different spaces. First, they will emphasise a disembodied and deified Maradona turned into a saint, and, given the confusing circumstances of his death, into a martyr. Second, they will make us hear the sound of a nation. In July of 2021, the Argentinian team beat Brazil 1–0 in the Maracanã Stadium in the Copa América final. Several memes pictured Maradona like a good-natured God that had guided the Argentinian team from heaven. A few weeks earlier, a new sound event had taken place in Argentina. On Twitter, the AFA (Argentinian Football Association) invited fans to shout together to commemorate the 35th anniversary of Maradona's iconic second goal against England in 1986: "On June 22nd at 16:09 play the commentary of Diego's goal against the English at full volume. And when the ball goes into the net again, we're going to roar out into the sky. Let's celebrate it again!" Maradona was evoked not only by his name but through the fundamental sound of football: the goal cry. "Maradona" and "goal" merged into a common sound that bounced directly on the word/sound/concept Argentina. Maradona consubstantiated with the land. That, too, seems to be his destiny.

Sound and immanence and/or sound and transcendence. The Maradonian sonorous dithyramb leaves us at this critical point and perhaps the new musical generations will be able to assimilate this dialectical tension without much difficulty. Right now, new songs where Maradona acts as a sound "blow", like a tattoo, continue to emerge. "Diego Maradona" (2020) by the German pop band Provinz goes in that direction. The chorus, introduced by a long melisma that occupies five of the eight bars, repeats his name like a mantra: "Ah ... Diego Maradona/Ah Diego Maradona". The music is euphoric, instrumentally dizzying, and supported by open, catchy choruses. It is a different song from the listening point of view: Maradona is entangled in a sound that escapes the rhythms and styles typical of rock and Argentinian popular music, and the rudeness that the rap, trap, and hip-hop songs mentioned try to convey. In an interview with the band, Warner Music Germany says: "Provinz turns the analogy of the rise and fall of Diego Maradona into a hymn to sweet power and the sense of immortality of youth, behind which there is always a looming sense of emptiness and

foolishness".¹⁴ For this band coming from a town of shepherds and farmers near Ravensburg, there is apparently nothing much to do or to fight for. They declare themselves numbed by the geography – although they also refer to youth in a wider sense.¹⁵ The song says: "And I'm bored, because down here behind the hill/ There is usually nothing to celebrate, so shoot me in the head/I'm about to eat, which helps me to forget/But before we leave/Shoot me like Diego Maradona". Maradona emerges as a luminous reflection, as if his name were a bullet that immediately acts on our consciousness, a radical and mobilising presence.

Just as Maradona marked his body with symbols of contemporary culture, now he himself is a mark for the new generations. It remains to be seen what the future sounds and echoes his song will bring in the years to come.

Notes

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- 2 Vj Awax is a musician and producer from the island of Mayotte. In February of 2020, he released his single "Maradona" with the St Unit & McBox. The lyrics appeal to the rebellion of marginalised classes.
- 3 For an approach to mass behaviour in football, cf. Herrera.
- 4 The participatory sound of the stadium is synchronised with a choreography: "the most common gesture involves an arm extended diagonally towards the sky, accompanied by a forward and backward movement of the forearm and a fairly loose wrist" (Herrera, 2018: 482).
- 5 Around the year of the song by Los Piojos and in "his visits to the different places in Argentina, an interesting phenomenon occurred: (Maradona) was surrounded by the affection of the public outside the stadium, and thoroughly booed the pitch" (Alabarces, 2002: 154).
- 6 In the chapter "Rhythm and Time in the Soundscape", Schafer refers to the heart, the breathing, the pace, and the nervous system as rhythmic patterns of humanity, and develops the existing links between these rhythms and the creative practice. "At least Walter Benjamin has referred to the subject when suggesting that, in Proust, who was asthmatic, the reader experiences a syntax that insinuates a fear of suffocating" (Schafer, 1993: 313).
- 7 Available at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jn8xiec7vpA&ab_channel=lalomunoz
- 8 See: *La Nación*: <https://www.lanacion.com.ar/espectaculos/musica/10-canciones-dedicadas-diego-maradona-nid2520928/>; *Infobae*: <https://www.infobae.com/teleshow/infoshow/2020/11/27/maradona-la-maquina-de-inspirar-canciones-los-mejores-temas-que-le-compusieron-a-lo-largo-de-su-vida/>; *Página 12*: <https://www.pagina12.com.ar/308001-canciones-para-maradona>; *Olé*: https://www.ole.com.ar/maradona/canciones-diego-maradona-todas_0_NcrHbxQ4B.html; *Marc*: <https://www.marca.com/tiramillas/musica/2020/11/25/5fbc966dca474188478b45fe.html>; *CNN*: <https://cnnespanol.cnn.com/2020/11/25/maradona-y-la-musica-escucha-las-canciones-que-algunos-artistas-le-dedicaron-al-astro-del-futbol/>
- 9 Andrés Burgo points out this change of status: "The ball buzzes out of Maradona's foot and crosses the line. It is not a goal, it is football alchemy, and is, also, as if an eternity lightning fell on the Azteca Stadium. Time speeds up and, at the same time, stops: it becomes marble, it is sealed in bronze, it is engraved in the memory of

- millions of people around the world and that moment begins to be, forever, an eternal moment" (2016: 194–195; our translation). For the Maradonian Church, the "Maradonian Easter" is celebrated on June 22, the day of resurrection (Caldeira, 2007: 23). The commentary for the entire match was published as a book, titled *Barrilete cósmico* [Cosmic Kite] (Morales, 2013). Over time, action and commentary became dependent on each other: when we watch the move, we hear the sounds. When we hear the sounds, we see the move.
- 11 Available at <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sBiGYUblb6Y>.
- 12 For Deleuze, a "sound assemblage" occurs when a voice disregards the task of "sustaining the sound" and only relates to the timbre, that is, to itself. "With the timbre [the sung, spoken voice] discovers in itself a structure that makes it heterogeneous to itself and gives it a power of continuous variation" (Deleuze and Guattari, 2002: 100). Maradona's voice is enough to summon all the parts (parameters) that constitute a sound, to find the common sound, according to Thomas Mann, "a simple howl that passes through all the degrees" (*id.*).
- 13 Available at <https://www.boletinoficial.gob.ar/detalleAviso/primera/5237540/20201125?suplemento=1>.
- 14 Read the full interview at: <https://www.warnermusic.de/news/2020-04-17/provinz-schiessen-sich-ab-wie-diego-maradona-seht-das-video-zum-neuen-song>.
- 15 Referring to their latest production "*Zu spät um umzudrehen*" (Too Late to Turn Around, 2020), the band calls on the youth to get involved and commit to global politics: "the provinces are becoming political. Because even if 2020 was in a sense a year of social stagnation, it was also the most politically uneasy year Black Lives Matter, lateral thinker demonstrations, plus a long-simmering discussion on a nearing climate catastrophe: as a thoughtful, young person, you cannot be apolitical these days". <https://provinzband.com/>.

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